International Herbarium

S.No	Herbarium	Year Established	Acronym	Number of specimens
1.	*Museum National d'Histoire Naturelle*, Paris, France	1635	P ,PC	10,000,000
2.	New York Botanical Garden, Bronx, New York, U.S.A	1891	NY	72,00,000
3.	Komarov Botanical Institute, St.Petersburg (Leningrad), Russia	1823	LE	71,60,000
4.	Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, England, U.K	1841	K	70,00,000

National Herbarium

S.No	Herbarium	Year Established	Acronym	Number of specimens
1.	Madras Herbarium BSI campus, Coimbatore	1955	MH	4,08,776
2.	Central National Herbarium West Bengal	1795	CAL	2,00,000
3.	Jawaharlal Nehru Tropical Botanical Garden and Research Institute Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala	1979	TBGRI	30,500
4.	Presidency College Herbarium, Chennai.	1844	PCM	15,000

illustrations and also a collection of more than 1,75,000 prints, books, photographs, letters, manuscripts, periodicals, maps and botanical illustrations.

5.8 Classification of Plants

Imagine walking into a library and looking for a Harry Potter story book. As you walk into the library you notice that it is under renovation and all the books are scattered. Will it not be hard to find the exact book you are looking for? It might take hours. So you decide to come the next day when all the books are arranged according to the genres. One rack for adventure, another for Detective, Fantasy, Horror, Encyclopaedia and so on. You automatically know Harry Potter is in the fantasy section and it takes less than ten minutes for you to find it. That is because the books have been classified and arranged according to a system.

Similarly there is a vast assemblage of group of plants in the world. Is it possible to study and understand all of these? No. Since it is difficult to study all these plants together, it is necessary to device some means to make this possible.

Classification is essential to biology because there is a vast diversity of organisms to sort out and compare. Unless they are organized into manageable categories it will be difficult for identification. Biological classifications are the inventions of biologists based upon the best evidence available. The scientific basis for cataloguing and retrieving information about the tremendous diversity of flora is known as **classification**.

Classification paves way for the arrangement of organisms into groups on the basis of their similarities, dissimilarities and relationships. The purpose of classification is to provide a systematic arrangement

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